GATEWAY TO WEALTH

HARSHIL MATHUR, 30 SHASHANK KUMAR, 31

Co-founders, Razorpay, **Bengaluru**

THE NEXT 100 ENTREPRENEURS

> **"You can't build a payments company out of a garage. We needed bank partnerships, but several of them rejected us. These were things we didn't understand about the business"**
>
> **HARSHIL MATHUR**

Like many start-ups, fintech unicorn Razorpay, founded in 2014, had a shaky beginning. A bank had asked founders Shashank Kumar and Harshil Mathur, both IIT Roorkee graduates, to make a security deposit of Rs 25 lakh to service their business loan. It eventually fell on Kumar's grandfather to bail them out. Kumar and Mathur look back at those initial struggles with a smile. Razorpay, a payments gateway for small and medium businesses, has grown phenomenally to become India's second most-valuable fintech start-up, after Paytm. With the recent Series-F fundraise of around $375 million (about Rs 2,840 crore), it has raised its valuation to $7.5 billion (Rs 56,800 crore) from $3 billion (Rs 22,700 crore) in April 2021. The company recently launched Razorpay Rize, a programme focused on early-stage and bootstrapped start-ups. Mathur hopes to add 100,000-odd start-ups to the Rize network over the next two years. ■

–Shwweta Punj

BANK BUMPS Nearly a hundred banks had rejected Razorpay as a payments solution provider, prompting Kumar and Mathur to—at one point—even consider giving up their venture and moving into the e-commerce space

SHARP SENSE
Mathur (left), Kumar

